

How Do I Integrate All of This?

A habit of curiosity is the foundation to knowing what you love and value. Your spending will evolve as you get to know yourself better. Something you think you love now can be something you learn you only loved one part of, and you can start to invest in that part without wasting money on the part you don't care about as much.

Asking ourselves better, less judgmental questions will help us accurately discover what we like, what brings us joy, the lifestyle we are most enthused about, and the person we want to become. This type of refinement brings clarity to nearly every decision we will make regarding our personal lives. As we ask:

What is it about me that is drawn to this thing?

What about my experiences, upbringing, or personality causes me to find myself in this pattern?

What am I most proud of?

What brings me the most joy?

These discoveries, born out of curiosity, don't just impact spending, investing, and saving, but can also influence our careers and life trajectories. When we refine and grow our identity as an employee, subcontractor, freelancer, or entrepreneur, we can find ourselves in roles that are more suited for us. This can lead to increased enjoyment, expression of self, and contentment. And dare I say, possibly more money? Granted, your job doesn't have to be your passion, but it can align with your values, and that's a beautiful thing.

You are likely to meet your values most accurately when you have a fuller understanding of who you are and what makes you tick. It's what can lead to sustainability and longevity far beyond a prescribed set of rules or "shoulds" and "musts" imposed on you by financial gurus or society at large. When you've put in the work and are making decisions around what actually matters to you, not what others have told you should matter, you get to make the rules!

The actions you take with your money based on your curiosity will allow you to see you don't actually love everything. You like a lot of things, you love some things, and not all of it actually requires you to spend. The adjustments you make as a result will sometimes be small shifts in mindset, sometimes they'll be big one-time decisions, and other times they will be